CDR is the widely used mortality measure. It is popular, because it is very easy to compute. However, it is only a crude measure of mortality, which does not take into account of the age and sex, on the whole, of the population/community/region. The probability of death may not be same at all ages. Hence, if the age distribution of two different communities are not similar, then comparing the communities based on their *CDR* can mislead. Also, use of *CDR* may again be misleading, since the probability of death may vary over gender, though they are at the same age.

(ii) Specific Death Rate

Mortality pattern may differ in different sections/segments of the population such as age, gender, occupation *etc*.

Specific Death Rate (*SDR*) can be calculated exclusively for a section of the population. The *SDR* can be calculated for a group of persons, who are distinguished by age or gender or occupational class or marital status. The formula to calculate *SDR* is

$$SDR = \frac{D_S}{P_S} \times 1000,$$

where

D_S refers to the number of deaths in a specific section of population during the given period, and

P_S refers to the total number of persons in the specific section of population during the given period.

*SDR*s can be calculated for any age group, gender, religion, caste or community. If the death rates are calculated for different age groups, say, 0-5 years, 5-15 years, 50-60 years, they are called age specific death rates (*ASDR*s). In the age group $(x,x+n)$, all the persons in the population or in its section, who have attained the age of x years and the persons with age less than $x+n$ years, are included in the age group.

If

$D(x,n)$ denotes the number of deaths in the age group $(x,x+n)$ recorded in a given region during a given period, and

$P(x,n)$ denotes the number of persons in the age group $(x,x+n)$ in the region during the same period, then

ASDR for the age group $(x,x+n)$ for the given region during the period is given by

$$ASDR(x,n) = \frac{D(x,n)}{P(x,n)} \times 1000.$$

The death rates, calculated for persons belonging to different gender, is called as gender specific death rate. The *SDR* can also be used to compare the death rates due to different kinds of seasonal diseases such as *dengue*, *chikungunya*, *swine flu*.

The *SDR* helps to measure the death rates for different sections/segments of the population unlike *CDR*. *ASDR* and *SDR* for gender can be used to compare the death rates of the respective sections of the given population in different regions.

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